Teacher and cover plan

Design and Technology LAUNCH Spring 2 Week 1 Thursday 25 February 2027 P1 Year A

Design a useful card stand

Weekly outcome verbatim: CONSTRUCTION: design a product to solve a problem.

LAUNCH Weekly Spring row 203. Year A. Resilience & Change. One 40-minute lesson for a small group aged 14 to 16.

Prepare

Read the invented Sam brief, specification prompts and three design starting points. Use the pupil book first. Prepare one paper card 80 mm wide by 60 mm high if available, plus a large sketch view. No cutting, joining, tool demonstration or personal object is required for this outcome.

A non-specialist cover adult can draw a triangle with a U retaining channel and explain base, support and card rest. Use the adult model as a think-aloud, then fade it. Pupils produce three different annotated ideas, even with supported drawing or spoken labels. Do not tick three pre-drawn models as completed pupil designs.

Timing

Stage	Minutes
Arrival	5
Starter	3
I do	5
We do	7
We do 2	5
Independent	8
Review	4
Exit	3

Total 40 minutes. Models and support fit inside these stages. Books first; oral, signed or pupil-directed records are confirmed by the pupil.

The problem and clear design checks

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Arrival 5 minutes

Say and do: Read the invented brief. Show or describe a paper card 80 mm wide by 60 mm high. Demonstrate it lying flat without asking for personal possessions or difficulties. Ask what Sam needs to read and why the stand must hold itself up. Today is planning; no cutting or joining is required. Use the last minute for a calm settling pause.

Check and response: Ask: What is the problem? Expect the card falls flat and is hard to read while working. Re-read the brief if the answer only names decoration.

Starter 3 minutes

Say and do: Turn the need into three short checks: card fit and message view, stability, safe handling. Explain that a specification is a list of checks a design must meet. It describes success, not a made product result. Ask the pupil for one useful check in their own words.

Check and response: Ask which is easier to check later: looks nice or stands on its own with the card. Expect the second; ask how they could check it after making.

Modelling and comparing ideas

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I do 5 minutes

Say and do: Think aloud one folded-stand idea. Draw a base, sloping support and U-shaped retaining channel; label the 80 by 60 mm card. Add: wide base may help it stand; U channel may catch the card edge. Use may because the unmade design has not been tested. Model one reason, then fade the final label to a pupil suggestion. Do not present the model as the pupil's work or only acceptable design.

Check and response: Ask what makes a label useful. Expect it names a part and says how it helps, such as base helps the stand stay upright. A neat outline without explanation is not enough.

We do 7 minutes

Say and do: Use three quick shape prompts. A folded triangle has a broad base; a slot base and backplate need a grip that suits the actual thin card; a braced back needs secure joins and a card rest. These are starting points, not tested products. Pupils can change a shape or suggest another. Compare against the same checks. Use property, feature, effect as short spoken chunks. Plan in any language.

Check and response: Ask the pupil to point to a different support feature in two ideas. If they repeat only the colour, re-point to base, slot or brace and ask how it supports the card.

Hinge and own design record

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We do 2 5 minutes

Say and do: Hinge answer is no. Colour alone does not show card support or stability. Re-point to the brief, then model: a broad base may help it stand on its own. Parallel check: a sketch shows a U channel; has the actual card passed a slip test? No, the design predicts an effect but the made stand must be tested later. Recheck after a brief reteach.

Check and response: Move on when the pupil links a feature to the problem and separates a design prediction from an actual test. If not, choose Supported and compare two feature labels with adult-led prompts.

Independent 8 minutes

Say and do: Use one route. Suggest about three minutes for quick sketches, two for labels, two for choosing and one to check. Sketches can be rough; record real features and purposes. With access support, the pupil may direct sketches or describe three distinct ideas and confirm a scribe's record. Do not reduce the three-idea requirement. The pupil may choose a taught starting point but must own the choice and reasons.

Check and response: Check three distinct ideas, two useful labels per idea, three checkable design points, a selected idea and two purpose-linked reasons. Check card dimensions and any proposed stand size; do not invent a measurement or completed test.

Review and next maker

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Review 4 minutes

Say and do: Offer a private adult review, or a peer comment only by consent. Check the choice against the specification rather than awarding a test pass. Let the pupil change a label, shape or reason and record why. The adult notes any design or tool questions for Week 2. Use the last minute to organise books and return any demonstration item.

Check and response: Pupil confirms their final idea and scribed words. Record the actual page and support. If a key design point is missing, mark it to complete before a cutting list is approved.

Exit 3 minutes

Say and do: Ask for a short own-word choice and reason, privately if preferred. Keep the actual brief, specification, three ideas and decision for Week 2. Name the build-planning step without starting it. Unfinished planning stays honestly marked.

Check and response: Evidence is the pupil's specification, three annotated ideas and chosen design with reasons, actual date, location and support. It is not proof of making or testing. Record only what happened.

Keep for Week 2

Retain the actual brief, specification, three annotated ideas, chosen idea with reasons, dimensions, question and support. The adult approves later material, cutting list and tool access separately. No product result is inferred from planning.

Access and adult support

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Cognition and Learning

Read one design check at a time. Use three simple shape prompts and a repeated part, job, reason frame. Keep card dimensions visible. Fade a model to labels, then to an own-word choice.

Communication and Interaction

Accept pointing, speech, signing and pupil-directed scribing or drawing. Give thinking time and a choice before an open question. Read every final idea and reason back for correction.

SEMH

Keep the client and problem invented. No personal possessions or difficulties need to be shown. Offer private review and a calm pause. Put any tools down first and agree a safe return.

Sensory and Physical

Use a large diagram, a spoken shape description or adult drawing directed by the pupil. Do not force handling. Plan later grip, cutting and joining support before any practical tool use.

EAL

Plan in any language. Pair client, brief and base words with a simple sketch or gesture. Use part, job and reason as short spoken chunks. Preserve pupil meaning in confirmed scribing.

Literacy and Numeracy

Read mm as millimetres. Keep 80 mm by 60 mm beside the card sketch. Model one short part and job label, then fade to a sentence start. Record proposed sizes clearly without treating a picture as a measured template.

Materials free fallback

With no card, paper, ruler, printer or tools, hear the brief and picture three different stand shapes. Describe each one and two useful labels, by speech or signing. Choose one with a reason linked to Sam's problem. An adult records exact confirmed words when a recording method is available; mark transcription pending until it exists. Keep physical sketches, measuring, making and product tests pending where not done.

Where this leads

Product designers turn a user's small problem into a clear brief. They compare ideas and explain why a design may work before a maker cuts material.